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Subject: [External] AI Action Plan
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This is a fundamentally bad idea. The "guard rails" that this plan seeks to remove are the legal rights of the American citizenry, and the citizenry of the rest of the world, to own what they produce. The plan proposed would allow tech giants to pick the pocket of every man, woman and child in this country of their labor without a cent to compensate them. And this is just if they are trained on publicly available information. What if they are allowed to train on privately held information? These machines have no true intelligence to them. If trained on secret information, it can be made to reveal secret information. This has already been demonstrated.

Beyond the violation of our rights, an issue that should be a primary concern, there is also the fact that Large Language models are, by their very nature, will be incapable of reaching the goals promised. The models do not think, and truly do not process information. For all of their technical impressiveness, they are ultimately very similar to markov chains, chaining together a series of words that it predicts should go together. These models cannot, truly, analyze or synthesize information. They can only summarize - and even on that they are failing. The terminology for this phenomena in the AI industry is "hallucinating" but it's not a hallucination. It is a failure. And large language models fail often and regularly. Questions and statements can be phrased, either intentionally or by accident, to state that things that are well known to be dangerous to be safe. Things that are not a matter of opinion. Phrased correctly, you can get these models to tell you that mixing bleach and ammonia is safe. But a basic knowledge of chemistry will tell you that this is highly unsafe - that this is how you produce mustard gas. If the machines were capable of analyzing data, they would recognize that this is an error and correct. They do not. They cannot. Because the machine does not learn to think. It learns to repeat.

And this is the final thing to mention. Beyond the fact that these ideas would violate the rights of American citizens. Beyond the fact that these machines are incapable of thinking like we've been promised and assured. There is a simple factor to consider: garbage in, garbage out. If these machines are allowed to widely scrape everything for their data set, they will be filled with garbage data. Information that is wrong because it's outdated. Information that is wrong because of errors. Information that is wrong because it's being offered sarcastically. Information that is wrong because someone wrote it wrong on purpose. The machine cannot analyze. The machine cannot sort truth from falsehood from jest.

What happens when the answer given in jest is provided by the AI, and causes someone to die? Who is held responsible? Not legally, but morally: who is to blame? The machine? The machine cannot be held accountable for its actions. The user? The user treated a machine that they were told was a reliable source of information as a reliable source of information. Are we to blame them for not knowing things without being told them? What about the company that owns the machine? They can say "but our data says that's true. We only collected it, we did not create it." The original posters of this information? This information was a clear joke, made decades before the thought of a LLM scraping that information could even be imagined?

You, perhaps. After all, you removed the guard rails. Don't you have some responsibility in this matter?

But let's talk about that metaphor. Guard rails. Guard rails are there for a reason. They stop people from falling to their deaths. There are rarely, if ever, situations where guard rails prove to be a hindrance. Guard rails save lives. The only reason to remove guard rails is because you do not care about other people's safety.

Nothing good can come of removing the guard rails. It can only cause harm.

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